- Vital Statistics reflect the changing pattern of the population of any region, community or country in terms of vital events.
- Vital Statistics help to compare two different regions or communities or countries with respect to public health based on vital events.

8.1.2 Collection of Vital Statistics

The following are the five methods normally adopted for collecting data related to various vital events:

(i) Civil Registration System
(ii) Census or Complete Enumeration method
(iii) Survey method
(iv) Sample Registration System
(v) Analytical method

(i) Civil Registration System

Civil Registration System is the most common method of collecting information on vital events. It is an administrative procedure followed by governments, to record various vital events occurring in their population.

In this method, occurrence of the vital events such as births, deaths, marriages, migration *etc*., are registered. Many countries adopt this system. Registration is done with the Authorities appointed by the respective government. In India, registration of births and deaths are made compulsory by legislation, through an act *viz*., "The Registration of Births and Deaths Act, 1969". It came into force throughout the country through a gazette notification published in 1970.

(ii) Census or Complete Enumeration Method

Census presents a comprehensive profile of the country's population. Census is conducted in most countries at intervals of ten years. The complete enumeration method normally covers data regarding age, sex, marital status, educational level, occupation, religion and other factors needed for computing Vital Statistics. However, all these information are available for the census year only.

(iii) Survey method

Ad hoc surveys are conducted in areas where the recording of births and deaths has not been done properly and periodically, particularly in those areas where registration offices have not been established. However, survey records help to provide Vital Statistics for that region only.

(iv) Sample Registration System

Vital rates are required to monitor population growth, especially for the purpose of evaluation of family planning programmes in terms of their ultimate objective of controlling fertility.

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